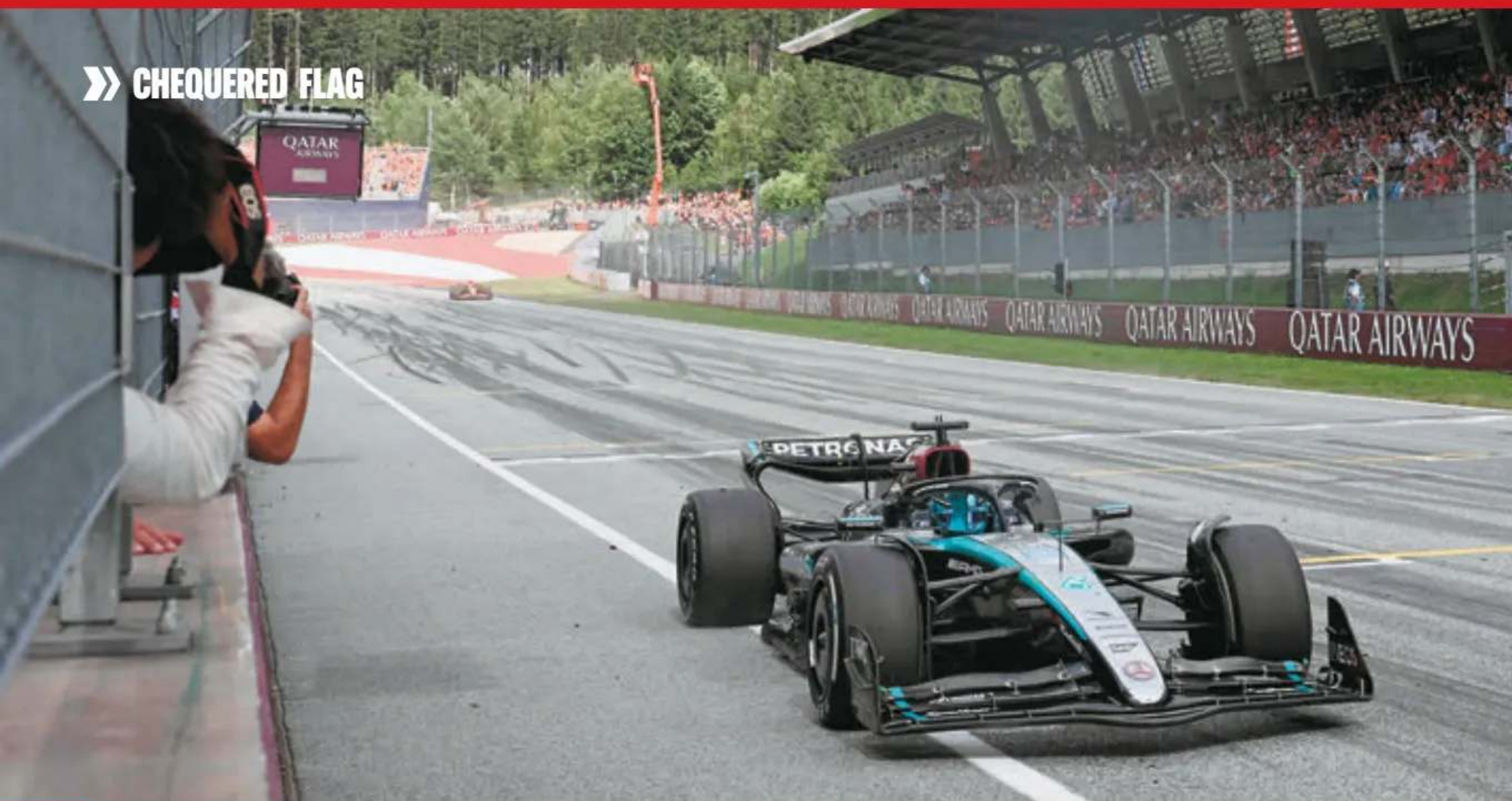




SLOW TURN OF THE TIDE

Red Bull may still be leading the standings, but its **advantage is slimming** with every race, especially after Max Verstappen's deliberate collision with Lando Norris.

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Ever since the Miami Grand Prix, where Lando Norris won his first race, it has become evident that Red Bull's advantage is shrinking, with McLaren closing the gap, and Ferrari and Mercedes not far behind.

Despite McLaren often having the fastest car, Verstappen came out on top in Canada and Barcelona thanks to his race craft in executing a strategy and Red Bull's operational sharpness.

The season has come alive

When Verstappen won four out of the first five races of the year, there

was a sense of resignation in the F1 paddock and among fans that Red Bull would win both titles this year at a canter and wouldn't be challenged even in 2025.

But things have dramatically turned in the last few races as McLaren has emerged as the clear and persistent challenger to the reigning champion.

The Spanish GP in Barcelona is usually a good barometer of where the

teams stand. The circuit layout perfectly blends fast, medium, and slow corners, including a long straight, exposing the car's aerodynamic performance.

So, when Norris took a sensational pole at the Circuit de Barcelona-Catalunya, it showed that McLaren now had a car as quick as the Red Bull.

Unfortunately, Norris fluffed the start and dropped two places, allowing George Russell to take the lead ahead of Verstappen. But it

